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This week we're broadcasting from Lech in Austria and I have as my guest Patrick Ortlieb, is that correct? That's correct, yeah. And welcome along to the program Patrick, it's very nice to have you on air. Tell me a bit about your background, I believe you were a bit of a great skier for Austria and you've had a great racing career.

Yeah, thanks for asking, it's quite a long time ago. I was in the World Cup circuit for over 12 years and I was very happy to win an Olympic gold medal at the Olympics in Albertville. I also won the World Championship in Nevada, all in downhill.

And for sure the biggest victory you can have as an Austrian downhill skier is to win the Honeycomb in Kitzbühel. It's one of the greatest races you have to win. And yeah, all in all it was a very, very nice career.

I travelled all over the world, I saw so many different ski resorts and I always come home back again. Here to Lech and your hotel here, tell us a bit about that. I had a fabulous lunch there with Hubert, one of the local personalities and it's really well set up.

Yeah, my parents founded a hotel when I wasn't born, it was nearly 50 years ago and they started a very tiny place and it grew up and grew up and my wife and myself, we are managing it now for over 20 years and we have very international guests, very nice guests. We have more than 85% returning guests, so that means they are satisfied how we make it. And yeah, we open during the winter season, we are located directly on the slopes, so ski in, ski out, perfect and everything you need for a nice winter holiday.

And just give us the name of the hotel. Yeah, our hotel is named Montana and yeah, it's like Montana, it's a state in the States, yeah. And the great thing is you've got that lovely big sun deck on the beautiful days, bluebird days, you can sit out there or even if it's just snowing, it's all nicely heated and everything, it's a great spot.

Yeah, people love to sit outdoor, doesn't matter how cold it is, so they want to enjoy fresh air and see the mountains and the sky, so we have everything heated and yeah, they enjoy the lunch outside and I'm very happy to be a host for all the guests. Now, you're a real local here in Lech in Austria and in the Alberg region and tell us a couple of your favourite little spots that you like to hang out, the local secret spots that people are coming over to Lech to ski, where should they head to apart from your hotel of course, Montana? Yeah, all in all, Lech is very famous for skiing, so skiing is the main thing where the guests are coming here, so we ski 330 degrees, so if you know when and which time you have to be where, you always have the sun, so that's very unique here, we don't have just one mountain on one face and ski all the day there, you ski, as I told, 360 degrees and there are little stops you can make, if you ski, for example, the Weisse Ring, that's one of the biggest ski tours you can make here, you make 22 kilometers and five and a half

thousand vertical feet, so once you stop first maybe at the Riffikopf, that's a very nice little restaurant where you start, you have your first hot chocolate and when you have it half done, you go to the Palmar, it's the best party location up there, great sun deck, best view, good music, so when you want to have a little fun, you'll be there and for the end, if you like it very cozy, like an Austria real hut, you go to the Hütalpe, you have nice fondue, candlelight, dark wood and how you expect Austria. Yes, it's a great place here, Lech and it's been such a pleasure to be here and can you give us the website for the Montana, if people want to visit, you know, how can they get there online? It's Montana and the place where we stay, so our website is montanoberlech, written in one word, dot at or com, whatever you want, we're very international, but it's montanoberlech, written in one word.

Patrick Ortlieb, gold medalist from Austria in the Winter Olympics, thank you very much for being on the program this week. Thank you so much for having this nice interview. And that's it for another edition of Travel Radio Australia, I'd like to thank all the contributors, Jeff Harrison, Francis Beasley, Sue O'Hearn from Travel Writers Radio, the Around the World Radio team in California, led by Arthur von Wiesenberger and of course featuring Peter Noon, Martha Bull and their guest Mike Thiel and Patrick Ortlieb at the Montana Hotel in Overlake, all these people made our show memorable this month, until we meet again next month with the next edition of Travel Radio Australia.

I'm Rens Weers wishing you all happy trials. You've been listening to Travel Radio Australia. The show was produced and hosted by Rens Weers.

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